

Wanderlust — Getting Started & Account Management

Creating an Account

Wanderlust uses secure authentication (powered by Passport.js) to protect user accounts.

- Sign up with a valid email address and password, or use an available social login option.
- Passwords must be at least 8 characters and are stored securely using industry-standard hashing — Wanderlust never stores plain-text passwords.
- After signup, you're automatically logged in and redirected to the homepage.

Logging In

- Go to the Login page and enter your registered email and password.
- If login fails, double-check for typos in your email or password. Accounts are not locked after failed attempts, but repeated failures may trigger a temporary rate limit for security.

Forgot Password

- Click "Forgot Password" on the login screen.
- Enter your registered email to receive a password reset link.
- Reset links expire after a set period for security — if yours expired, simply request a new one.

Updating Your Profile

- Once logged in, go to your Profile page to update your display name, contact details, or profile photo (uploaded and hosted via Cloudinary).
- Profile photo uploads support standard image formats (JPG, PNG, WEBP) up to the platform's size limit.

Logging Out & Session Management

- Sessions are managed securely; logging out clears your session on the current device.
- If you're logged out unexpectedly, this is usually due to session expiration — simply log back in.

Deleting Your Account

- Account deletion requests can be submitted from the Profile settings page or by contacting support.
- Deleting your account removes your saved listings, bookings, and personal data associated with your profile.

Common Issues

Issue	Likely Cause	Resolution
"Invalid credentials" error	Wrong email/password	Reset password
Not receiving reset email	Email in spam folder / typo in email	Check spam, re-enter email carefully
Profile photo won't upload	Unsupported file type or size too large	Use JPG/PNG under size limit
Logged out randomly	Session expired	Log in again